

METRO AG SCI Project: Scope to Indicators

Scope

Scope statement

This project examines METRO AG's customer-facing digital services for professional HoReCa customers in Europe, with a focus on its e-commerce ordering platform and mobile commerce app, in order to assess how these capabilities contribute to customer retention and competitive positioning over a 3–5 year horizon.

Out of scope

Internal digital tools, logistics systems, supplier-side software, credit management, invoicing workflows, and other non-customer-facing technologies are excluded.

Key Intelligence Topics

Category	KIT
KIT 1 — Strategic decisions & actions	Effectiveness of METRO AG's digital ordering channels in supporting customer retention and customer convenience in the European HoReCa market.
KIT 2 — Early warning	Emerging changes in customer expectations, competitor strategies, and digital service trends affecting METRO AG's digital positioning over the next 3–5 years.
KIT 3 — Key players & positioning	Competitive positioning of METRO AG's e-commerce platform and mobile commerce app relative to traditional and digital-native players in the European HoReCa sector.

Key Intelligence Questions and Indicators

KIT 1 — Strategic decisions & actions

KIQ	Indicators
KIQ 1.1 What functionalities and services do METRO's e-commerce platform and mobile app offer to support ordering and customer interaction?	Product search and filtering functions; order placement and reorder functions; delivery or click-and-collect options; customer account and order history features.
KIQ 1.2 How have METRO's digital ordering channels evolved over the past 3–5 years in terms of features, usability, and service scope?	Launch announcements of new functions; app version updates or release notes; new service categories added to the platform; public statements about digital transformation or multichannel expansion.
KIQ 1.3 How do METRO's digital ordering channels contribute to customer retention, as reflected in repeat use, convenience, and loyalty signals?	Customer reviews mentioning repeated use; reviews mentioning convenience or ease of ordering; repeat-order or reorder features; loyalty program references or saved preferences.

KIQ 1.4 What are the main strengths and weaknesses of METRO's digital ordering channels from a customer perspective?	Positive app-store review themes; negative app-store review themes; complaints about usability or bugs; praise for convenience, speed, or product range.
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KIT 2 — Early warning

KIQ	Indicators
KIQ 2.1 What emerging digital trends are shaping ordering behavior in the HoReCa sector?	Patent filings related to digital ordering, customer-facing commerce platforms, and AI-driven interaction tools; volume and growth of patent activity in this space over recent years; technology domains and innovation themes emerging in the patent corpus.
KIQ 2.2 How are competitors — including incumbents and digital-native entrants — evolving their digital ordering capabilities?	Patent filings by direct and adjacent competitors in B2B digital ordering and commerce platforms; geographic and corporate concentration of digital ordering IP; new entrants surfacing in recent patent activity; scientific publications on B2B e-commerce platform evolution and partnerships.
KIQ 2.3 What changes in customer expectations, such as speed, personalization, and ease of use, are influencing digital ordering behavior?	Scientific literature on customer expectations in digital ordering (speed, personalization, convenience, ease of use); academic studies on B2B and HoReCa buyer behavior; thematic shifts in research on digital service quality and user experience over the recent period.

KIT 3 — Key players & positioning

KIQ	Indicators
KIQ 3.1 Who are the main competitors offering digital ordering solutions to HoReCa customers in Europe?	Competitor websites and product pages; industry reports naming key players; app store presence of competitor ordering tools; analyst comparisons of competitive sets.
KIQ 3.2 How do competitors' digital ordering platforms compare to METRO's in terms of features, usability, and service quality, and what advantages or gaps emerge for METRO?	Feature comparison across websites or apps; app-store ratings and reviews; public demos or screenshots; differences in delivery, pickup, or support services; METRO feature set versus competitor feature set; comparative customer ratings; evidence of missing features compared with rivals; public statements about differentiation.
KIQ 3.3 How do customers perceive METRO's digital services compared to competitors' digital services?	Review sentiment mentioning competitor comparisons; customer testimonials; forum or social media comments; review language about switching or preference.